FLEET TEAM DIGEST

737MAX-FTD-34-18005

Issue Title : Flight Management Computer System (FMCS) - Update 14.0 Operational Software

Airplane Model	ATA	Minor Model(s)
737MAX	3461-00	-7, -8, -8200, -9, -BBJ

Other Model(s)	ECCN
737NG	9E991

Originated Date	Last Revised Date	Created On
04/10/2018	01/18/2021	01/06/2021

Estimated Completion Date	Next Update Date

Revision Description

All documents are now released, closed FTD.

Applicability

All 737MAX Airplanes before Airplane Line Number 7887.

Description

Update 14 (U14) Flight Management Computer Operational Program Software (FMC OPS) includes Future Air Navigation System 2 (FANS 2) capabilities in order to meet both European and North Atlantic mandates (ACB B-S003-562-16-04822). FANS 2 changes are confined to the Flight Management Computer (FMC) Operational Program Software (OPS). This functionality also requires a Communication Management Unit (CMU) with Aeronautical Telecommunications Network (ATN) Router. The CMU with ATN Router would be used together with U14 to support the European Data Link Mandate.

The FMC U14 OPS enhancements will include:

- Future Airspace Navigation System 2 (FANS-2) functionality

- Airway to airway intersection determination

- Vertical Navigation (VNAV) temperature compensation

- VNAV path tracking improvements

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- Cruise Descent and Cruise Climb Speed Targeting

- Active Descent VNAV improvements

- Localizer Performance with Vertical (LPV) approach capability

- Textual Display of Route Clearance

- Airplane Based Augmentation System (ref ACB B-S003-2017-ACB-0019)

Details related to these changes are discussed in the attachment to this FTD as well as in the referenced Airplane Configuration Bulletin (B-S003-562-16-03219) and Boeing Service Letter 737-SL-34-251, dated 7 Feb 2020.

Background

ATS Data Link refers to a set of data link functions used to communicate with Air Traffic Control. This includes:

Controller-Pilot Data Link Communication (CPDLC) which provides direct link to ATC for purposes of clearance negotiation and information exchange.

Automatic Dependent Surveillance (ADS-C) which provides Automatic Position Reporting and Aircraft Information.

ATS Facilities Notification (AFN)/Context Management (CM) which provides ATC with airplane's "address" to initiate CPDLC and ADS-C connections.

There are two types of ATS Data Link, Future Air Navigation (FANS) which utilizes existing ACARS network for message routing which is primarily used for ATC in Oceanic and Remote Airspace. The other, Aeronautical Telecommunications Network (ATN) uses new ATN network for message routing, primarily used in European Continental airspace. FANS2 combines these two current data link configurations, FANS CPDLC and ATN CPDLC.

Prior to U14 these were mutually exclusive. FANS2 includes both FANS CPDLC, ATN CPDLC as well as ADS-C

Status

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Boeing has recently discovered a must-fix issue related to the U14 FMC software which has impacted system certification. The condition is related to how the FMC utilizes sensor input data from the ADIRU during dual FMC operation. A fix to address this issue is included in the U14 FMC OPS. This issue is discussed in Boeing Service Letter 737-SL-34-251. Boeing understands that the FAA is considering rule making based on this item.

Boeing has re-committed Production Revision Record 39146 to incorporate U14 into production 737 MAX airplanes and allow retrofit of U14 into 737 MAX airplanes per Boeing Service Bulletin 737-34-3065. The U14 software is scheduled to be incorporated into 737 MAX Airplane Line Number, 7887 and on, however all airplanes that were in storage prior to this L/N will be delivered with the U14 OPS installed with exception to 737 MAX airplanes epuipped with a Heads Up Display (HUD) system. Those airplanes equipped with a HUD system will be delivered with U13 OPS installed until the U14.1 FMC OPS is available.

Boeing is planning an Out of Sequence update (U14.1 FMC OPS) to address compatibility issues present with the U14 FMC OPS and HGS-6000 HUD STC installed in the 737 MAX airplane during production. U14.1FMC OPS is discussed in Boeing Fleet Team Digest article, 737MAX-FTD-34-20002.

Interim Action

No Interim Action required

Final Action

Boeing committed Production Revision Record 39146 to incorporate the U14 FMC OPS into production 737 MAX airplanes and allow retrofit of the U14 FMC OPS on 737 MAX airplanes per Boeing Service Bulletin 737-34-3065. As stated previously, Boeing understands that the FAA is reviewing this issue for possible regulatory action.

The U14 FMC OPS is scheduled to be incorporated into 737 MAX airplanes starting at Airplane Line Number 7887. Undelivered airplanes prior to this line number that have been in storage at Boeing will also be delivered with the U14 FMC OPS. Airplanes that are equipped with the HGS-6000 will be delivered with the U13 FMC OPS until the U14.1 FMC OPS becomes available. Details related to the U14.1 FMC OPS are provided in 737MAX-FTD-34-20002.

Milestones

Note: Target dates are based upon currently available status and have risk of future revision.

Production Incorporation: L/N 7887

Service Bulletin Available: 9-Dec-2020 (Complete)

Parts Available: 9-Dec-2020 (Complete)

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Reference Categories

Reference Type	Reference Number	Revision Number	Reference Date
Service Letter (SL)	737-SL-34-251		02/07/2020
Service Bulletin (SB)	737-34-3065		
Production Revision Record (PRR)	39146		
Airplane Configuration Bulletin (ACB)	B-S003-562-16-03219		06/01/2018
Airplane Configuration Bulletin (ACB)	B-S003-2017-ACB-0019		11/21/2017
Airplane Configuration Bulletin (ACB)	B-S003-562-16-04822		11/08/2016
Fleet Team Digest Article (FTD)	737MAX-FTD-34-20002		

Related Categories

- New Equipment : Information on new parts available now or soon to be introduced

Attachments:

a) U14 Update

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